

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL · EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT · PREPARED FOR MSS INVESTMENTS HOLDING · JUNE 2026

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT & ENGAGEMENT PROPOSAL

Swiss Payments Platform From Architectural Promise to Commercial Reality

PREPARED BY Thomas K Matecki Former CTO, Zilch · CEO, NICO Capital Ltd	SUBMITTED TO MSS Investments Holding Vincent de Cannière, Chairman Investment Committee	CLASSIFICATION Strictly Confidential Not for Distribution	REVIEW DATE June 2026 Post Technical Review, 22 June 2026
---	--	--	--

STRATEGIC CONTEXT

The Platform, the Execution Gap, and Why It Matters

Swiss Payments has been built with genuine ambition — a multi-tenant fintech infrastructure platform covering fiat payments, digital asset custody, compliance, and B2B financial services. The engineering team has delivered substantive foundational work: multi-tenant architecture from the database layer up, Fireblocks institutional custody, a double-entry ledger, and a transaction engine capable of real-time processing. These are not trivial achievements.

The technical review of 22 June 2026 identified, however, a measurable and material gap between the platform's current operational state and the minimum viable threshold for commercial launch, regulatory defensibility, and institutional client acquisition. Critically, this review was conducted without sandbox or demo account access, with limited platform exposure, and without the opportunity to engage all key stakeholders. What was observed must therefore be understood as the surface of a more complex picture — the visible indicators of deeper structural gaps that only a structured on-site assessment can fully map.

"The platform is not broken. It is unfinished. In regulated finance, the distance between unfinished and live is not measured in features — it is measured in liability, regulatory exposure, and the confidence of the clients you are seeking to win."

THE WEIGHT OF WHAT IS BEING BUILT

Knowledge Without Operational Experience Is the Most Costly Gap in Fintech

The BaaS and multi-tenant infrastructure sector has produced a consistent and instructive pattern: platforms with sound architecture and capable engineering teams that failed not because the technology was wrong, but because the leadership layer above it lacked the operational depth to navigate compliance obligations, commercial realities, and regulatory scrutiny at scale. The table below is not a list of cautionary tales — it is a diagnostic framework. Every failure mode listed has a direct, observable parallel in the current state of the Swiss Payments platform.

PLATFORM	OUTCOME	ROOT CAUSE	PARALLEL IN SWISS PAYMENTS
Synapse	Collapsed 2024 \$100M+ frozen	Engineering-led. Compliance treated as secondary. No experienced compliance leadership at operator level.	Compliance module is a case-management UI. No SAR workflow. No automated monitoring rules. Identical trajectory.
Railsr	Administration 2022	Sound architecture; no commercial governance. Headcount scaled without corresponding revenue or product discipline.	35 FTE, 2 product managers, no CPO, zero live revenue. Engineering function is materially ahead of all others.
Wirecard	Fraud / €1.9B loss	Regulatory opacity exploited. Licensing described vaguely. Compliance governance was presentation, not substance.	"Many licences" was the direct response to a question about FINMA and EMI status. This is not a sufficient answer at any stage of maturity.
Pocket / Anna	Premature launch Expensive pivot	Launched before compliance infrastructure was ready. FCA scrutiny post-launch consumed runway.	Mid-July go-live cannot be achieved as currently structured. The cost of post-launch remediation is 5–10× the cost of preparation.
Nium	Thriving · \$1B+	Experienced compliance and product leadership secured early. Licensing clarity treated as commercial infrastructure, not admin.	The path available to Swiss Payments — with the right leadership deployed now.

This platform handles fiat balances, digital asset custody, cross-border payment rails, and AML obligations across multiple jurisdictions. The liability exposure — to MSS Investments as capital provider, to Swiss Payments as operator, and to every tenant that onboards — is real and material. A generalist consultant cannot address this. A software agency executing against a specification cannot address this. What is required is an operator who has personally navigated every one of these dimensions at institutional scale, under regulatory scrutiny, with investor capital at risk. That is precisely what this proposal provides.

PLATFORM FINDINGS — JUNE 2026

Eight Material Deficiencies — Initial Assessment Only

The following deficiencies were identified during a time-constrained initial review conducted without demo account or sandbox access, and without the opportunity to engage all relevant stakeholders. They represent the observable surface — the full picture will only emerge through the structured on-site due diligence programme described below. Each finding below should be understood as indicative, not exhaustive.

SEVERITY	AREA	FINDING	IMPLICATION
CRITICAL	Infrastructure	Demo served from localhost:3000. No staging/production environment parity.	Any published go-live date is commercially indefensible until resolved.
CRITICAL	Payment Rails	Currencycloud integration at 100% error rate. DOWN with no active incident response at time of review.	Core payment rail inoperative. Immediate remediation required.
CRITICAL	Card Programme	No card issuer or programme manager selected. Realistic procurement-to-live: 90–180 days minimum.	Mid-July card go-live is not achievable under any current trajectory.
CRITICAL	Compliance	Compliance module is a case-management UI. No SAR workflow, no automated TM rules, no risk scoring.	Regulatory liability in any jurisdiction where AML obligations apply to the platform.
SIGNIFICANT	Onboarding	KYB entirely manual. No automated workflow, no in-platform operator tooling.	Unscalable at volume; creates compounding compliance exposure with each tenant.
SIGNIFICANT	Trading	B2C2 integration at 5.06% error rate — fails any institutional operational due diligence standard.	Would be rejected by any regulated enterprise client in standard ODD review.
SIGNIFICANT	Organisation	35 FTE, 2 product managers, no CPO. Engineering-led without product governance or commercial function.	Platform optimised for build, not for revenue, compliance, or client accountability.
SIGNIFICANT	Licensing	"Many licences" was the direct response when asked about FINMA, EMI, and SRO scope.	Untenable for any tenant due diligence, investor data room, or regulatory engagement.

ENGINEERING PRACTICES

The engineering team demonstrates sound foundational practices — version control, code structure, and general process discipline are in place. The gap is at the delivery architecture level: teams are not yet structured into concurrent, parallel squads operating simultaneously against a properly prioritised backlog. Introducing dedicated product, compliance, infrastructure, and QA streams — working in parallel rather than sequentially — would materially unlock delivery capacity, accelerate QA cycles, and replace the current aspirational ETAs with credible, evidence-based delivery dates that the business and its investors can rely upon. This is a product and delivery leadership gap — not a reflection on the engineering team.

THE PROPOSED PARTNER

Thomas K Matecki — Directly Applicable Track Record at Institutional Scale

The Investment Committee will note that this engagement is not a consultancy arrangement in the conventional sense. It is a partnership with an operator who has personally delivered at the scale, under the regulatory conditions, and across the precise technical dimensions that Swiss Payments is attempting to reach. The following credentials are directly applicable — not adjacent experience, but exact prior-art precedent.

ZILCH TECHNOLOGY / Former CTO	Architected and scaled the full technology platform of Zilch from inception through \$2B+ valuation and 3,000,000+ active customers across multiple institutional fundraising rounds. Direct, hands-on experience with: card programme procurement and deployment; AML/KYC compliance engineering under FCA scrutiny; real-time payment rail integration (SWIFT, SEPA, Faster Payments); Fireblocks institutional custody at scale; high-availability infrastructure architecture; and multi-jurisdictional regulatory navigation. This is exact prior-art for what Swiss Payments is building — not adjacent experience.
NICO CAPITAL LTD / CEO & Co-Founder / Co. No. 16839544	Building Nico Money (nico.money), Nico Pay, and Nico Bank — a multi-product neobank ecosystem targeting the Caribbean and Dominican Republic: 11M+ population, \$10B+ annual remittance inflows, zero dominant neobank incumbent. Currently in active £10M seed raise. NICO Capital is a prospective anchor tenant of Swiss Payments infrastructure from day one of any engagement, generating contracted MRR and providing Swiss Payments with its first named, institutionally credible white-label client.
NEXA9 / Founder / nexa9.co	London-based full-service technology and software house with deep fintech delivery capability. Ready to deploy immediately: senior full-stack engineers, product designers, QA engineers, compliance module developers, and technical architects. Nexa9 operates as a direct extension of the mandate — complete accountability for outcomes, not outputs.

PHASE ZERO — THE NON-NEGOTIABLE STARTING POINT

14 Days On-Site in Dubai — Verified Assessment Before Any Mandate Commences

No engagement of this scope — financial, operational, and reputational — proceeds on the basis of a remote assessment. Before any mandate commences, Thomas K Matecki will conduct a structured 14-day on-site programme in Dubai, working directly alongside the Swiss Payments leadership, engineering, compliance, and banking partner teams. This produces a verified, independently-produced assessment of every dimension of the platform that becomes the definitive basis for mandate scope, remediation priorities, and the 90-day execution plan. No assumptions. No remote inference. Only what has been seen, tested, and verified in person. All logistics are arranged by and at the cost of Swiss Payments / MSS Investments Holding.

WEEK 1	FOCUS & ACTIVITIES	WEEK 2	FOCUS & ACTIVITIES
Technical Architecture Days 1–3	Full codebase and database architecture review. All integration audits — Fireblocks, Currencycloud, B2C2, Kraken, Wise, Bvnk, Modulr. CI/CD pipeline. Security posture. Infrastructure topology. Localhost-to-production gap analysis.	Commercial & Regulatory Assessment Days 8–11	Full licensing documentation review. Banking partner agreements. Tenant pipeline and commercial model. Revenue model stress-test. Competitive positioning and ICP analysis.
Compliance & Risk Days 4–5	AML/CFT framework documentation review. KYC/KYB workflow walkthrough. SAR procedures assessment. Transaction monitoring rules. PEP screening. Sanctions compliance posture. Regulatory licensing scope.	Organisational & Delivery Assessment Days 12–13	Leadership interviews across all functions. Team capability mapping. Product roadmap and backlog review. Sprint and delivery process assessment. Org structure and gap analysis against required capabilities.
Banking & Partners Days 6–7	Sumsub KYC integration review. Fireblocks custody configuration and policy setup. Kraken Pro trading setup. Banking rail health check and error rate triage. Partner contract review. Settlement flow verification.	Board-Ready Output Day 14	Verified findings report delivered to Investment Committee. Prioritised remediation plan. Revised go-live date with full rationale. 90-day mandate execution plan. Mandate scope confirmed and signed.

LOGISTICS

All travel, accommodation, and ground transportation costs for the 14-day programme are covered by Swiss Payments / MSS Investments Holding. These costs are entirely separate from and in addition to the mandate engagement fee. Thomas K Matecki will coordinate all logistics directly with the relevant contacts upon mandate confirmation.

DUAL STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP

NICO Capital × Swiss Payments × MSS Investments A Compounding Value Architecture

The most significant dimension of this proposal is not the executive mandate — it is the dual-track strategic partnership that creates compounding value across two MSS-adjacent assets simultaneously. Each track makes the other more valuable. Thomas K Matecki sits at the centre of both, with fully aligned financial incentives across both outcomes.

TRACK A / NICO Capital as Anchor Tenant	THE COMPOUNDING EFFECT / Why Each Track Strengthens the Other	TRACK B / MSS Investments as NICO Capital Seed Participant
NICO Capital (nico.money) executes a white-label tenant agreement with Swiss Payments from day one of the engagement. NICO becomes the platform's first named, commercially active anchor tenant, generating contracted MRR immediately. Thomas K Matecki manages delivery accountability on both sides, eliminating the execution risk gap that typically characterises third-party tenant arrangements.	MSS has stronger grounds to invest in NICO when NICO is already a live Swiss Payments tenant — infrastructure execution risk is materially de-risked. Swiss Payments presents a more compelling proposition to future tenants when a Zilch-pedigree neobank is already operating on it. Both assets appreciate precisely because of the other.	MSS Investments participates in NICO Capital's £10M seed raise. A £500K–£1M strategic participation provides exposure to the Caribbean and DR market: 11M+ population, \$10B+ annual remittance inflows, zero dominant neobank incumbent — led by an operator with a \$2B+ fintech delivery track record. Independently compelling, and de-risked by the Swiss Payments infrastructure relationship.

EXECUTION ROADMAP

Critical Path — Phase Zero Through Day 90

PHASE	FOCUS	KEY DELIVERABLES	LED BY
PHASE 0 14 Days Dubai	ON-SITE DUE DILIGENCE	Full technical, compliance, commercial, and organisational audit. Every integration tested directly. All licensing documentation reviewed. All key team members engaged. Verified findings report and 90-day mandate plan delivered on Day 14. Fully expensed by Swiss Payments / MSS.	TKM On-Site (expensed)
DAYS 1–14	IMMEDIATE TRIAGE	Currencycloud resolved or substituted. B2C2 error rate addressed. Staging/production environment deployed. Licensing clarified via external legal counsel. Incident response protocols established. NICO Capital LOI as Tenant #1 executed.	TKM + Nexa9
DAYS 15–30	FOUNDATION	Card programme: issuer shortlisted, commercial conversations initiated. KYB automated workflow designed and scoped. Credible go-live date agreed across all stakeholders. MSS/NICO seed investment conversation opened on a parallel track.	TKM
DAYS 31–60	BUILD	Transaction monitoring rules implemented. SAR workflow operational. Production environment fully deployed. KYB live in sandbox. Mobile application reviewed and submitted to stores. Card issuer agreement in active negotiation.	Nexa9 + Swiss Payments

PHASE	FOCUS	KEY DELIVERABLES	LED BY
DAYS 61–90	COMMERCIAL ACTIVATION	NICO Capital live as Tenant #1 — contracted MRR on platform. Card issuer agreement executed. First 3 external tenants in active due diligence. Investor-grade data room complete. MSS/NICO Capital seed term sheet in progress.	TKM

PROPOSED MANDATE STRUCTURES

Three Frameworks — Investment Committee Selection

Three mandate structures are presented in ascending order of scope and strategic integration. Each is commercially viable on a standalone basis. Professional fees reflect an operator with a demonstrated \$2B+ fintech delivery track record. The on-site 14-day due diligence programme in Dubai — detailed on page 4 — precedes all three frameworks and is covered in full by Swiss Payments / MSS Investments Holding.

	FRAMEWORK A Advisory & Technical Oversight	FRAMEWORK B ♦ RECOMMENDED Transformation Partner	FRAMEWORK C Full Executive Mandate
Role	Fractional CPO / Strategy Officer 2 days/week minimum	Head of Product & Transformation or MD Product — embedded, not advisory	Interim CEO or COO Full mandate, board-level authority
Engagement Fee	£38,000 / month	£48,000 / month	£65,000 / month
Nexa9 Services	From £35,000/month (targeted modules)	£65,000–£90,000/month (team of 4–6 engineers)	£110,000+/month (primary tech partner)
Equity	1.5%	3–4% + success fee at £1M ARR	5–7% + exit kicker at £5M ARR or M&A;
On-Site DD	14 days Dubai Fully expensed	14 days Dubai Fully expensed	14 days Dubai Fully expensed
Term	3 months initial (rolling monthly)	6 months minimum (30-day performance review)	12 months minimum (quarterly board review)
Key Outputs	- Platform & compliance audit - Card programme guidance - Licensing roadmap - NICO as pilot tenant - NICO/MSS seed introduced	- Compliance engine rebuilt - Card issuer contracted (30 days) - KYB automation live - NICO as Tenant #1 — live MRR - MSS investor in NICO seed 10 tenants targeted	- Full platform productisation - Team restructure via Nexa9 - Investor-grade data room - NICO co-marketing rights - MSS as NICO seed lead - M&A; positioning programme

All engagement fees are structured under formal Executive Engagement Agreements governed by English law with LCIA arbitration. Nexa9 services are contracted under a separate Technology Services Agreement. Equity terms are subject to legal structuring and shareholder consent. A 30-day probationary performance review applies to all frameworks.

INVESTMENT COMMITTEE — RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

A Considered Path Forward

01	Confirm the On-Site Due Diligence Programme Agree the 14-day Dubai schedule and coordinate logistics at your convenience. This is the natural foundation for any mandate — producing the verified, first-hand assessment on which everything else is built. Thomas K Matecki is flexible on timing.
02	Indicate Mandate Framework Preference A written indication of the preferred framework — or a 60-minute conversation to discuss it — is sufficient to initiate the Executive Engagement Agreement process. Framework B is recommended, though the team's own context and priorities should guide the selection.
03	Initiate the Nexa9 Scoping Conversation An initial scoping call between Nexa9 and the Swiss Payments technical lead can proceed in parallel with any other discussions. Understanding the current architecture and backlog is valuable groundwork regardless of the mandate framework ultimately chosen.
04	Execute the NICO Capital Letter of Intent as Tenant #1 A lightweight, non-binding LOI costs neither party anything, generates the first evidence of commercial traction for Swiss Payments, and can be executed at any point — it does not need to wait for a mandate to be in place.
05	Open the NICO Capital Seed Investment Conversation When the MSS investment team is ready, NICO Capital's seed round materials are available for review. This is an independent track that stands on its own merits — and is further de-risked by the Swiss Payments infrastructure relationship.

Thomas K Matecki

thomas@nico.money +44 7423 239335

nico.money · nexa9.co NICO Capital
Ltd · Co. No. 16839544

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL. Prepared exclusively for MSS Investments Holding. This document contains commercially sensitive, financially material, and legally privileged information. Reproduction or distribution without the express written consent of Thomas K Matecki or NICO Capital Ltd is prohibited. This assessment represents the independent professional opinion of Thomas K Matecki and does not constitute financial, legal, or regulatory advice. © 2026 NICO Capital Ltd / Nexa9. All rights reserved. Registered in England & Wales.